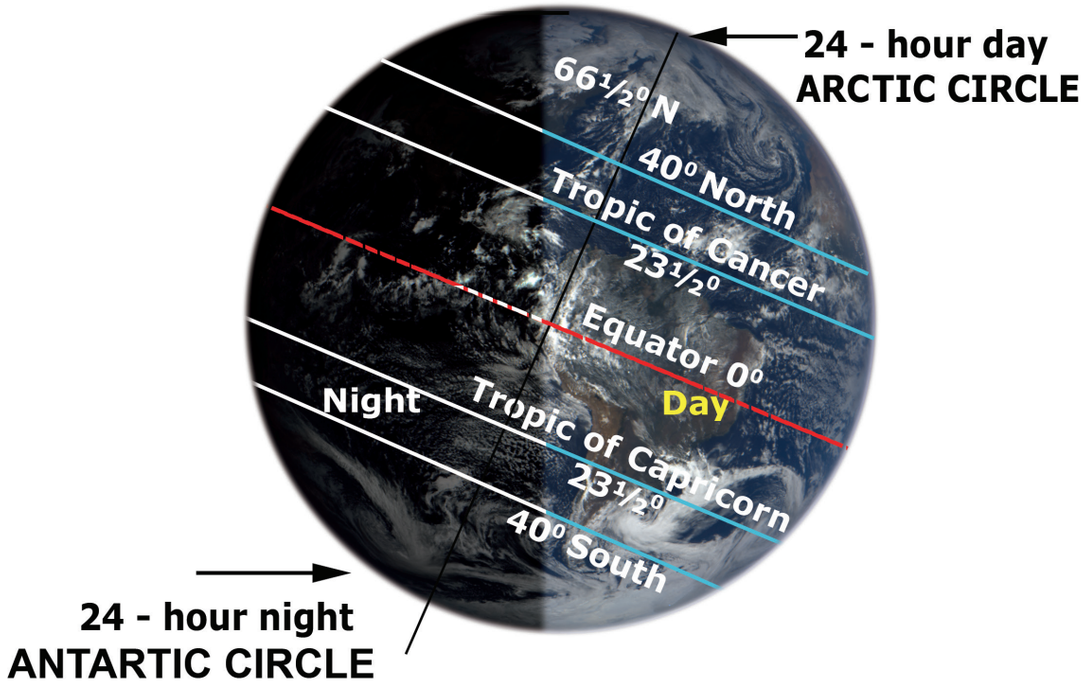


Figure 2.11 Circle of Illumination

in an orbit at an average distance of 150 million km. The distance of the earth from sun varies time to time due to the elliptical shape of the orbit. About January 3rd the earth is closest to the sun and it is said to be at *Perihelion* ('peri' means close to and *Helios* means sun). At Perihelion, the distance is 147 million km.

Around July 4th the earth is farthest from the sun and it is said to be at *Aphelion* (Ap means away and *Helios* means sun). At Aphelion the distance of the earth is 152 million km away from the sun.

The period taken by the earth to complete one revolution around the sun is 365 days and 6 hours (5 hours, 48 minutes and 45 seconds) or 365¼ days. The speed of the revolution is 1,07,000 km per hour. The speed is 30 km per second. The bullet

Difference between Rotation and Revolution

Rotation	Revolution
Spinning of the earth from west to east on its axis.	Movement of the earth around the sun in its elliptical orbit.
It takes 24 hours to complete a rotation (or a day)	It takes 365¼ days to complete one revolution (or a year)
It is known as the daily or diurnal movement.	It is known as the annual movement of the earth.
Rotation causes days and nights to alternate, tides, deflection of winds and ocean currents and also gives the earth its shape.	Revolution results in the varying lengths of day and night, changes in the altitude of the midday sun and change of seasons.

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